

"I AM GOING TO STAY."



PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

A.R. Antulay

Maharashtra Chief Minister A.R. Antulay may have said of Arun Shourie in the wake of the Trustgate revelations, "He is not the conscience keeper of the nation". But Shourie's meticulous research into Antulay's fraudulent Rs 50-crore Indira Gandhi Pratibha Pratisthan Trust Fund scandal—wherein Antulay asked builders to donate to the trust in exchange for favours—meant he couldn't dodge the fire of the 14 column-inch bombshell Shourie dropped on his readers on August 31. Another feather in the firebrand investigative reporter's cap.

From Pune to Oregon

On May 1, having discoursed daily for nearly 15 years, Bhagwan Rajneesh aka Osho entered a three-and-a-half-year period of public silence. On June 1, he left for the US, moving to a farm in Oregon with his followers.



BHAWAN SINGH

- IBM introduces the personal computer, IBM PC, heralding the start of the computing age.
- John Lennon's (*Just Like*) *Starting Over* and the album *Double Fantasy* topped music charts just weeks after his death.
- Ronald Reagan (below) was sworn in as President of the US, ushering in an era of "Reagonomics" to

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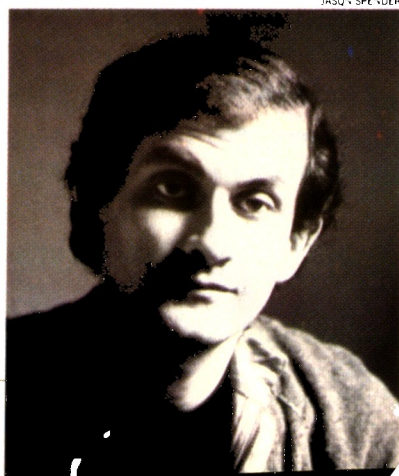
bring down inflation, and unemployment.

- Peter Sutcliffe, a truck driver later convicted as the "Yorkshire Ripper" for murdering 13 women, was arrested in England.

1,186 was the number of armed dacoits the Uttar Pradesh Government claimed to have killed over the course of the year. A result of a deliberate, stepped-up action against the growing dacoit menace, this was the highest kill-count in the state's history.

MAGIC CARPET RIDE

Salman Rushdie took the world—and the Booker Prize jury—on a magic-carpet ride across the Indian sub-continent with his *Midnight's Children*. With his brand of masala magic realism, the Bombay-born, Cambridge-educated writer redrew the map of Indian literature in English and provided a generation of immigrant authors a template to translate their essentially Indian experiences into something universally palatable. The no-show *Grimus* far behind now, this was a new, quirkier Sir Salman on display.



JASON SPENDER